

Company: General Mills

Job Profile: Software Developer

Offer Type: Internship Only

Internship Stipend: 35000

CTC:

Location: Mumbai

Process Date: 14th September 2024

Placement Process:

1. **Round 1 Online Assessment** [All who registered]

The **First round (60 Questions)** was the online assessment having 3 sections (No Negative Marking):

Section 1: 15 Minutes, 15 Questions

About: **Logical based thinking.** Questions were asked on patterns and reasoning.

Useful Tip: Questions might appear tricky. Since this will be the first section you will be attempting - the key part here is to balance your time as 15 minutes is less for this section. Go through all the questions and solve according to easiest to difficult strategy.

Section 2: 15 Minutes, 15 Questions

About: **English Language based.** Questions were asked on grammar, arranging the sentences in the chronological order, comprehension etc.

Useful Tip: Section is straight forward with the basic level of English you will be able to crack this easily. Time is not an issue here, just have to think calmly.

Section 3: 40 Minutes, 30 Questions

About: **Technical Based.** Questions were ranging from the topics of Object Oriented Programming, Database Management Systems, Computer Communication Networks, Data Structures and Algorithms etc.

Useful Tip: Questions here were of easy to moderate level. A key part here is to take the smart guess when not sure. Some of them are objective based theory while some will be solving according to a data structure or so.

2. **Round 2: Technical Interview Round** [18 Candidates appeared for this round]

This round will last for about *45 minutes to 1 hour*. The best tip would be to remain calm and smile in this situation. The interviewer is judging you on the depth of your knowledge and the way you explain which highlights your communication.

As any interview would start, the first question asked was – Introduce yourself. The key part here is to spend a bit more time and highlight the aspects that you want the interviewer to ask you. This is

going to form the base of your interview. I talked about my internship experience and current projects in web development and also the brownie points that I had won multiple hackathons and worked at NGO. Consequently, the first half shifted on my projects and work experience where I was asked to explain about it in depth and then further was asked situational based questions – Were these collaborative projects? If yes and a conflict arose then how would you manage it? (Another question) If some of your team mates were not on the same page then what would you do? (Another one) How would you approach people when you had to build a project on a tech stack that you don't know? The way I answered these questions was that I took examples of the projects and explained each one of them highlighting that I have been in these situations and have leadership qualities.

Then the next part of the interview was on the aspects they had mentioned in their job description – Data Analytics and Cloud Computing. (Questions like – What is cloud computing?) They don't expect me to have in depth knowledge on them but I gave an overview on them and they were happy about it.

The third phase of this interview spanned on the DBMS. I was asked about SQL and what I knew about it. Then I was asked to design a schema for a School. I used the "Thinking Out Loud" method – which is essentially whatever I wrote I spoke about why I wrote it and then added the constraints (NOT NULL, UNIQUE, PRIMARY KEY, FOREIGN KEY). I did this so that the interviewer know the process in which I am thinking. After this I was asked to explain the Schema. The interview then asked me SQL Queries on the same. The queries were related to the Schema I made, and one of the questions on which the interviewer emphasized was the difference between the HAVING and the WHERE clause.

Since I had an interesting resume, they again came back to my work experience and then ended the interview by asking – Why choose General Mills? Researching about the company helps here. Overall the round was based on resume and you should know it thoroughly anticipating the questions that can arise.

9 Candidates went to the next round.

3. **Round 3 – HR Based Round** [9 Candidates Appeared for this Round]

This was a purely HR based round with common questions. Mine was the shortest one lasting about 20 minutes. There were two people in the panel. They were looking at how you are going to tackle these questions. It started by walking them through your resume. This similar was as in the Technical Round but here my focus was on the fact that I worked at NGO which resonates with the company policy of giving back to society. Some of the questions were:

- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- If not engineering then what will you be doing? And why?
- One impression – good and bad that your friends will have about you? Why would they have that?
- What do you know about General Mills?
- Why choose General Mills?

The answers that you give can lead to follow up questions on that. The key is to keep calm and have a smile on your face and then give the reply to best of your ability. Highlighting points relevant to the company is always beneficial as they see that your goals align with theirs.

In the end 4 people got the internship offer.

Useful Tips:

- **Computer Fundamentals:** Keep learning and practicing OOP, DBMS, DSA, and CCN.
- **Do your homework:** Research the company you're interviewing with.
- **Be clear and confident:** Focus on explaining your ideas clearly.
- **Be yourself:** Honesty and authenticity are important in the HR round.
- **Know your stuff:** Be ready to talk about your work experience projects and technical skills.
- **Format your resume:** It is always a good practice to tailor your resume according to the company and the important points in your resume should be highlighted.